

2c. Content of Media messages (H409/01)

Section A – News

Section A consists of **two** linked, comparative **in-depth** studies that focus on contemporary news in the UK, requiring learners to explore how and why newspapers and their online counterparts are evolving as media products and the relationship between both online and offline news. As in-depth studies, newspapers and online, social and participatory media must be studied in relation to **all**

four areas of the media theoretical framework, including all related theories and all relevant contexts (the subject content table detailing all of the above follows the end of Component 02).

In this section, learners must study the following set products.

Media Industries and Media Audiences

Media Form	Set Product	Guidance to aid comparison
Newspapers	One complete edition of the <i>Daily Mail</i> and one complete edition of <i>The Guardian</i> selected by the centre.	Each pair of newspapers selected should be published on the same date.
Online	The <i>Mail Online</i> and <i>The Guardian</i> websites.	Key pages from each newspaper's website, including the homepage and at least two other pages which help illustrate the scope, scale and content and appeal of each website.
Social and participatory media ¹	The <i>X</i> (formerly Twitter), <i>Facebook</i> and <i>Instagram</i> feeds linked to from the main <i>Mail Online</i> and <i>The Guardian</i> websites where available.	A consideration of how active each newspaper's social and participatory media feeds are, including which articles are featured and which generate the most audience participation.

NB: All set products selected for study in this section must be from the September onwards of the first year of teaching a two-year course. For example, from September 2017 onwards for a candidate entering for assessment in June 2019.

Please turn over for an indicative content list.

The following indicative list is given as guidance and is not exhaustive.

For example, in relation to media industries and audiences learners should consider:

- the overarching relationship between technological change and newspaper production, distribution and circulation
- the impact of digital convergence on the production, distribution and circulation of news organisations' offline and online offerings
- the significance of issues of ownership and economic factors, including the range of each newspaper's print and online content, the use of online monetization features such as paywalls, subscriptions and games
- the content and appeal of each of the set products and how this is used to target, reach and address different audiences
- how audience may use and interpret the same media in different ways
- how audiences can be reached through different media technologies and platforms
- the impact of the regulatory framework on the newspaper industry and the impact of online news and social and participatory media on regulation.

Media Language and Media Representation

Media Form	Set Product	Guidance to aid comparison
Newspapers	Two front covers from the <i>Daily Mail</i> and two front covers from <i>The Guardian</i> selected by the centre.	Each of the two 'pairs' of front covers should be published on the same date and feature a similar lead article that is of national or international significance, for example this could be a political, economic or sporting event or a lead article related to conflict, crime or health.
Online	At least two articles from the <i>Mail Online</i> website and at least two articles from <i>The Guardian</i> websites.	Each chosen website article and the associated social and participatory media feeds should link to the themes or issues represented in the front covers chosen.
Social and participatory media ¹	The associated X (formerly Twitter), <i>Facebook</i> and <i>Instagram</i> feeds for the online articles chosen by the centre from the <i>Mail Online</i> website and <i>The Guardian</i> websites where available.	For example, if a <i>Daily Mail</i> front cover lead article is a 'Brexit' related story then learners should study the associated <i>Mail Online</i> article and X, <i>Facebook</i> and <i>Instagram</i> feeds for this story and consider how media language and representations in those feeds position the audience and engage participation.

NB: All set products selected for study for this section must be from the September onwards of the first year of teaching a two-year course. For example, from September 2017 onwards for a candidate entering for assessment in June 2019.

The following indicative list is given as guidance and is not exhaustive. For example, in relation to media language and representations, learners should consider:

- the way events, issues, individuals and social groups are represented through processes of selection and combination, including a consideration of the choices news media make
- the impact of industry contexts (for example ownership) on the choices news producers make about how to represent events, issues, individuals and social groups
- the ways in which representations constructed by news media make claims about realism
- the positive and negative use of stereotypes by news media and how representations may

invoke discourses and ideologies and position audiences

- the ways in which the use of media language by news producers incorporates viewpoints and ideologies
- how multiple meanings can be communicated across different news platforms and the impact of technology on media language (for example, post production editing of photos)
- the elements of media language used in newspaper front covers, online websites and social and participatory media such as locations, lighting, choice of camera shot, angle, typography, layout, address of content to the audience and editing and sound as appropriate.